than one might suspect. More importantly, these three have shown a willingness to collaborate to various extents with the Putin regime in the hopes of reviving Russia as a Super Power state.

Alexander Dugin's Eurasian Project

Born in Moscow in 1962, Alexander Dugin's father was a colonel in the intelligence service and his mother a scientist. In 1979, he entered the Moscow Aviation Institute but was expelled after two years for falling behind. Presumably, he eventually graduated from the Institute of Engineers of Melioration in Novocherkask in 1999.[1] In 1980, Dugin joined a clandestine group of intellectuals known as the "Black Order of SS" which researched the Nazi esoteric-occultist philosophy.[2] In the late 1980s, he joined the *National-Patriotic Front Pamiat* and began to work in the press. His ideas were influenced in this period by western right-wing and conservative thinkers such as Friedrich Nietzsche, Mircea Eliade, Karl Haushofer, and others.

Following the collapse of the Soviet Union, Dugin reconsidered his views on Communist ideology and turned to the European new-left and new-right, as well as the Russian émigré ideologies of National-Bolshevism and Eurasianism. As a result, in 1993, he took part in the "brown-red" anti-Yeltsin rebellion. Together with Eduard Limonov, he established the *National Bolshevik Party* that he subsequently left in 1998. Following the breakup with Limonov, he became an adviser of Genadii Seleznev, the Chairman of the Russian State Duma, and was close to Russian Prime Minister Evgenii Primakov, and later to President Vladimir Putin. He established his own *Eurasian Party* (later renamed the *International Eurasian Movement*) in 2002. The movement was based on Dugin's idea of a "Turkic-Slavic alliance in the Eurasian sphere," which was extremely important to the Kremlin during the Second Chechen War. In 2008, he became an unofficial ideologist of Putin's *United Russia* party, and simultaneously, a professor of sociology and head of the *Center for Conservative Research* in the Department of Sociology at Moscow State University, which he left in 2014. Since 2012, Dugin has been a member of the advisory board of the Chairman of the Russian State Duma, Sergey Naryshkin.

The totalitarian anti-western, anti-American, anti-liberal, and anti-bourgeois ideology led Dugin to support Putin's policy during the crisis in Ukraine in 2004, the Russian occupation of Abkhazia and South Ossetia in 2008, and also the 2014 occupation of Crimea and the unofficial intervention

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